

JHU - Krieger School of Arts & Sciences / Whiting School of Engineering

ASEN.2022.Fall.Project2

Course: AS.150.201.01.FA22: Introduction To Greek Philosophy
Instructor: Richard Bett *
Response Rate: 14/14 (100.00 %)

1 - The overall quality of this course is:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor		(1)	0	0.00%		4.36	4.15	3.85				
Weak		(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory		(3)	2	14.29%								
Good		(4)	5	35.71%								
Excellent		(5)	7	50.00%								
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%								
					02550100	Question	School level	Department level				
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School level	Mean	STD	Median	Department level	Mean	STD	Median
14/14 (100.00%)		4.36	0.74	4.50	18971	4.15	0.96	4.00	418	3.85	1.07	4.00

2 - The instructor's teaching effectiveness is:

Richard Bett

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Poor		(1)	0	0.00%										
Weak		(2)	0	0.00%										
Satisfactory		(3)	1	7.14%										
Good		(4)	5	35.71%										
Excellent		(5)	8	57.14%										
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%										
					0	25	50	100	Question	School level		Department level		
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School level		Mean	STD	Median	Department level		Mean	STD	Median
14/14 (100.00%)		4.50	0.65	5.00	21789		4.18	1.01	5.00	416		3.78	1.17	4.00

3 - The intellectual challenge of this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means						
Poor				(1)	0	0.00%								
Weak				(2)	0	0.00%								
Satisfactory				(3)	1	7.14%								
Good				(4)	7	50.00%								
Excellent				(5)	6	42.86%								
N/A				(0)	0	0.00%								
							0	25	50	100	Question	School level	Department level	
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School level		Mean	STD	Median	Department level		Mean	STD	Median
14/14 (100.00%)		4.36	0.63	4.00	18825		4.24	0.84	4.00	413		4.17	0.86	4.00

4 - The teaching assistant for this course is:

Response Option				Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means											
Poor	(1)	0	0.00%		4.77	4.25	4.27		0	25	50	100							
Weak	(2)	0	0.00%																
Satisfactory	(3)	0	0.00%																
Good	(4)	3	23.08%																
Excellent	(5)	10	76.92%																
N/A	(0)	0	0.00%																
Response Rate				Mean	STD	Median	School level		Mean	STD	Median	Question		School level		Department level			
13/14 (92.86%)				4.77	0.44	5.00	18727		4.25	0.99	5.00	414		4.27		1.06		5.00	

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5 - Please enter the name of the TA you evaluated in question 4:

Response Rate 13/14 (92.86%)

- Fearghus Horan
- Fearghus
- Fergus Horan
- Fearghus Horan
- Fearghus Horan
- Fearghus Horan
- Fergus
- Fearghus Horan
- Fearghus
- Fearghus Horan
- Fearghus Horan
- Ferghus
- Fearghus Horan

6 - Feedback on my work for this course is useful:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means								
Disagree strongly		(1)	0	0.00%										
Disagree somewhat		(2)	0	0.00%										
Neither agree nor disagree		(3)	1	7.69%										
Agree somewhat		(4)	2	15.38%										
Agree strongly		(5)	10	76.92%										
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%										
					02550100	Question	School level		Department level					
Response Rate		Mean	STD	Median	School level		Mean	STD	Median	Department level		Mean	STD	Median
13/14 (92.86%)		4.69	0.63	5.00	18737		4.06	1.05	4.00	412		4.20	1.04	5.00

7 - Compared to other Hopkins courses at this level, the workload for this course is:

Response Option		Weight	Frequency	Percent	Percent Responses	Means							
Much lighter		(1)	1	7.69%									
Somewhat lighter		(2)	0	0.00%									
Typical		(3)	7	53.85%									
Somewhat heavier		(4)	4	30.77%									
Much heavier		(5)	1	7.69%									
N/A		(0)	0	0.00%									
					0	25	50	100	Question	School level	Department level		
Response Rate	Mean	STD	Median	School level	Mean	STD	Median	Department level	Mean	STD	Median		
13/14 (92.86%)	3.31	0.95	3.00	18762	3.12	0.97	3.00	413	3.08	0.78	3.00		

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8 - What are the best aspects of this course?

Response Rate 10/14 (71.43%)

- I really liked the lecture style, and thought that the philosophical arguments made in the texts were explained in a very clear and easy-to-follow manner.
- The content is really comprehensive and serves as a great introduction to philosophy
- The best aspects of this are centered around the content. It is very comprehensive, particularly when it comes to the Presocratics. The readings are made accessible and discussed in way not that is focused historically but in a way where we consider the validity of these ideas.
- Professor Bett's lectures did a good job explaining the denser parts of the reading. He could also be pretty funny sometimes. Fearghus was one of the best TAs I've had in the major. I especially appreciated how transparent he was about his expectations for papers. It took a lot of the guesswork out of the writing process.
- Interesting lectures
- The best aspects of this course include the lectures and essay feedback. Professor Bett is a phenomenal lecturer who delivers thought-provoking and engaging lectures. It's evident he is passionate about the topics, not just because he is a translator of some of the texts, but because of how excited he gets when teaching the material. The excitement throughout the lecture hall is contagious. Essay feedback was always hyper specific, targeted towards clear issues, and emphasized improvement. The skills trained during section mainly focused on improving the quality of writing.
- The lecture notes were a very clear and helpful summary of the material. They allowed me to focus fully on the lecture and not worry about missing something in note taking that i would need later. Fearghus was an amazing TA as well and put in a lot of work to help us understand the material
- The material was very engaging, the TA discussions were a lot of fun and the focus on rigorous thought was great.
- The content
- We are able to ask the TA's questions during sections

9 - What are the worst aspects of this course?

Response Rate 10/14 (71.43%)

- Personally I would much rather write a paper than take an exam, so I would say that having the first assessment be an exam rather than a paper was probably my least favorite aspect.
- The material is too much to remember for the exams, where there are a lot of fact-based memorization
- The worst aspect of this course is probably that there is not a significant discussion portion, but mostly lecture
- I would guess that <10% of people did the readings before classes and sections, which made the discussions pretty awful.
- The workload. The amount of writing corresponds to WI course
- The worst aspects of this course include the discussion sections, which sometimes felt lackluster and uninteresting outside of the context of philosophy. I was not enthused to attend section, but once there I learned a lot. Where it lacked in excitement, it made up for it in covering the proper content and training us on writing essays.
- I did not enjoy the timed writings for the midterm and final. It was great that we got the questions ahead of time, but I feel that I was being tested on how fast I could write. I think I could have worked with the material better if there had been a third paper or smaller write ups rather than the exam essay questions
- The strange set up of the in person exams. Having to write and memorize an essay to rewrite live feels particularly strange.
- N/A
- The readings can be difficult to follow

10 - What would most improve this class?

Response Rate 9/14 (64.29%)

- My only suggestion to improve this course would be to switch the midterm exam to a paper. Other than that I thought it was a great course.
- The way it is tested. Could be more short papers rather than matching facts at the exam
- This class could be improved by more discussion on the Sophists
- I think adding a participation (or even a discussion post) grade would go a long way. It would incentivize people to actually do the readings before class. I know this might sound like hand-holding, but incentives matter and without them the typical Hopkins student is going to work on one of the other million assignments they have instead.
- Sometimes the material feels disconnected from reality because it is so abstract. More examples on the practical impacts or uses of the concepts taught would improve the interactability with the material.
- I would have liked a little more feed back on specifics of my essays but the feedback was very helpful already
- Ideally, just make the final exams a take home paper, rather than the set up of live writing an essay.
- More group activities/assignments to solidify knowledge/understanding
- More guidance towards the beginning of the course on how to write a proper philosophical essay

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11 - What should prospective students know about this course before enrolling? (You may comment on any aspect of this course such as assumed background, readings, grading systems, and so on.)	
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Response Rate	9/14 (64.29%)
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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Prospective students should expect to have to read some of the readings at least twice (once before lecture and once after lecture) to fully understand the arguments being made.• The reading gets very obscure because of the Greek and ancient context. The course is also very comprehensive so once you get used to the writing style of one of the philosophers, it quickly moves on to another.• Prospective students should know that this course is a great course to introduce philosophy and will teach how to write philosophical papers. It will focus on Presocratic, Plato, and Aristotle.• No assumed background. The readings aren't bad except for like the last two weeks.• Prospective students should know that the class requires effort to earn an A, but no background knowledge is required. This is an excellent course with fair grading. Lecture and discussion section is IMPORTANT to understand the material, which is very abstract. It is a great class and I would highly recommend it to anyone on campus.• The course is very clear and well taught. If you do the readings and pay attention you will do great• An intro course, so no background required, other than a willingness to engage in the material• Have fun!• It is good to ask questions and remain engaged |
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